

MSc in Corporate Financial Management 2026 – 2027

IDENTIFICATION:

Course title: Financial Reporting and Analysis

Campus: Paris & Lille

Time / Credits: 18-hour (Tutorials) / 4 ECTS

OVERALL DESCRIPTION:

Objective: The main objective of this course is to develop students' analytical skills and critical assessment of individual financial statements, and/or consolidated integrated annual reports in an international environment. It aims at preparing students for an in-depth examination and comprehensive analysis of various financial accounting topics, referring to the general framework of international financial reporting standards (IFRS). Nowadays, financial reporting objectives are much broader than just "crunching" or generating numbers. This course will illustrate that reporting involves a comprehensive knowledge of businesses to provide the information required by the many stakeholders.

Description: This module emphasizes on the fundamental tools and techniques in financial reporting and is customized for students entering postgraduate level studies. The module does not cover all IAS/IFRS standards, but students are expected to show they master the application of the IAS/IFRS standards for business analysis and valuation considered in the module. It is a foundation course for a professionally oriented program and is designed to develop students' capacity to reflect upon and critically analyze issues relating to financial strategy within the firm.

Prerequisites: Previous knowledge of financial accounting is required. therefore, participants should be familiarized with the basics prior to attending this module. An Accounting Prerequisites module has been developed and proposed to MCFM students to review the fundamentals of financial accounting, if needed.

LEARNING GOALS/LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

By the end of the module the students will be able to:

1. Understand the nature and the role of financial reporting, as a "language of business".
2. Review and analyze a complete set of financial statements: balance sheet, income statement, statement of retained earnings and cash flow statement.
3. Examine financial statements, individual or consolidated, prepared under IFRS standards and the additional information that are included into a local statutory accounting system to achieve the disclosure requirements,
4. Analyze the impact of different sets of accounting standards on financial statement analysis (such as horizontal and vertical analysis, ratios analysis and return analysis, segments contribution to performance and EPS), of separate or consolidated entities

ORGANISATION:

The teaching/learning methods used will develop students' abilities to work in team and encourage the development of communication skills. It thus provides an interdisciplinary perspective in this area of management.

The first general session will present the main objectives of the courses and draw a comprehensive comparison (similarities and differences) between IFRS and local GAAPs'. The subsequent sessions will be a combination of short lecture, in-class discussions, and cases studies. To enhance class participation, students should, at least, skim the assigned readings, tried to solve the practical exercises questions, and read the case assignments **BEFORE** each class-session. Cases used on the course have alternatively shorter or longer length and chosen to provide a global context. **Doing homework is essential: financial accounting and analysis cannot be learned just by reading materials; you have to actually do it to learn it.**

SESSIONAL TOPICS COVERED:

1. Financial accounting refresher, conceptual framework and principles,
2. Accounting for and presentation of assets,
3. Accounting for and presentation of liabilities and shareholders' equity
4. Income statement & statement of cash flows,
5. Individual vs. consolidated financial statements
6. Financial statements analysis techniques.
7. Non-financial & sustainability reporting

BIBLIOGRAPHY:

Reference textbooks -

1. Alexander D., Jorissen A., Hoogendoorn M., Van Mourik C., Kirwan C., Inwinkl P. & Michelon G. (2023), **International Financial Reporting and Analysis**, 9th Edition, Cengage Learning EMEA.
2. Martin S. Fridson & Fernando Alvarez (2022), **Financial Statement Analysis – A Practitioner's Guide**, 5th Edition, Wiley Finance Series.

Professional References -

3. BDO (2025), **IFRS at a Glance**, as at 31 December 2025 edition, BDO (available on K2).
4. KPMG (2025), **US GAAP Compared to IFRS Handbook**, November 2025, KPMG LLP (available on K2).
5. KPMG (2019), **IFRS Compared to French GAAP**, September 2019 (available on K2)

ASSESSMENT:

Assessment	Individual /Group	Type (oral, written)	Length of exam (when applicable)	Weight %
Continuous	Individual	Written	1-hour	40 %
Final	Individual	Written	2-hour	60 %

Continuous Assessment (40% of final grade):

To encourage regular work, a practical test will be administered **during** the semester to make sure the concepts and practical techniques taught have been understood. The test will be made of mini-cases, conceptual knowledge checking and analytical questions (contents and date will be released in due course).

Final examination (60% of final grade):

The final examination will be a combination of practical exercises and problems solving. It may cover any material taught in the module. It tests the students on their assimilation of the main concepts, on their ability to apply them judiciously on exercises and/or on their aptitude to analyze critically a situation (contents and date will be released in due course).

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY:

Plagiarism is copying another's work or ideas. This includes sections (sentences, tables, diagram) of books or articles, another student's work or text, diagram, data from the internet without proper referencing etc. Adding your name to group work in which you have not participated or letting a student who has not participated add his/her name to work is also considered as an offence and will lead to disciplinary action for all involved. Plagiarism in any assessed work (continuous assessment, examinations and projects) is considered as a serious offence and will lead to disciplinary action.

Other forms of academic dishonesty are subject to disciplinary sanctions. Academic dishonesty, other than plagiarism may take any number of forms such as submission of the work more than once whether the earlier submission was at another institution, unless prior approval has been obtained, cheating on an examination, aiding another student's dishonesty, unauthorized or inappropriate use of computers, calculators and other forms of technology in course work, assignments or examinations.

Tentative Schedule outline 2026

Financial Reporting & Analysis

Sessions	Topics: course details	References and/or pre-readings	Case studies / Application
1	The Role and Importance of Financial Reporting – An Overview - Presentation of financial statements (IFRS 18 vs. IAS 1) - Fair value measurement (IFRS 13) - accounting policies, estimates and errors (IAS 8)	Alexander et al. Part 1. Framework, Theory & Regulation Key Reading: HBS (2024), "<i>A Manager Guide to Finance and Accounting (under USGAAP)</i>", Harvard Business School Online.	
2	Financial reporting and selected accounting standards (Current & non-current Assets): - Inventories (IAS 2) - Analysis of accounts receivable & revenue from contracts with customers (IFRS 15) - Property, Plants & Equipment (IAS16) - Intangible assets (IAS 38) - Impairment of assets (IAS 36)	Alexander et al. Part II. Annual Financial Statements Chapters 9 – 13, 15 Key Reading: Travis W. Harms (2019), "<i>Basics of Financial Statements Analysis</i>", Mercer Capital Management	Sessional Exercises
3	Financial reporting and selected accounting standards (Other Liabilities & capital structure): - Loans vs. leases standard (IFRS16) impacts and disclosures requirement - Provisions, contingent assets & liabilities (IAS 37) - Earnings per share (IAS 33) - Shareholders' equity analysis	Alexander et al. Part II. Annual Financial Statements Chapters 16 - 18 Key Reading: PwC (2026), "<i>June year-end accounting reminders - IFRS Accounting Standards</i>", PwC Switzerland – Junel 2026	Sessional Exercises
4	Financial Analysis, basic approach: - Interpretation of financial statements - Techniques of financial analysis: ratios - Other techniques: trend & sensitive analysis - Quality of earnings & discontinued operations analysis - Impact of newly released IFRS 18 and IFRS 19	Alexander et al. Part IV. Financial Analysis Chapters 26 – 29 Key Reading: IMF (2025), "<i>Geopolitical Risks – Implications for assets price and Financial Stability</i>", IMF – Global Financial Stability Report (Chapter 2) – April 2025	Sessional Exercises
5	Financial Analysis, statement of cash flows & Group Accounts Review: - Statement of cash flows (IAS7) - Business activities reporting & analysis - Business combinations basics (IFRS 3) - Consolidated financial statements (IFRS 10 – 12)	Alexander et al. Part II. Annual Financial Statements Chapters 20 -21 Part III. Consolidated Accounts Chapters 22 – 2E	Sessional Exercises

6	Financial analysis, measures of performance & non-financial reporting: - Related party disclosures (IAS 24) - Investment in associates & Joint ventures (IAS 28) - Operating segments (IFRS 8) - Sustainability reporting (IFRS-S)	Alexander et al. Part IV. Financial Analysis Chapters 26 – 29 Alexander et al. Part V. Non-financial reporting Chapters 30 - 31	Sessional Exercises
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